

933
hydropower workers
among the missing, along
with 517 foreigners

Soldiers trying to drill through to
100 people
trapped in tunnels at multiple
hydropower projects

93,000
people may have
been affected by dis-
aster, says Red Cross

In Tibet, which is
largely inaccessible to foreign
journalists
**7 people dead &
554 missing**

Rescuers struggle in mud, 3k missing in Nepal, China

As time runs out, 682
bodies recovered,
over 4,400 rescued

BIDUR (NEPAL), AGENCIES

Rescuers in Nepal and China were battling on Saturday to locate thousands of people missing days after a deadly, tsunami-like wall of water and debris swept through the Himalayan region, engulfing entire villages.

Figures from both countries put the number of missing close to 3,000, with 682 bodies recovered — and reports of some dead possibly swept downstream as far away as India.

More than 4,400 people have been rescued or evacuated so far as rescuers race against time to reach remote settlements cut off by the destruction of roads and bridges. Rescue worker Kawan Koirala, from the Nepal Scout Disaster Response Team, said they were struggling in thick, leg-sucking mud.

“People want their family member’s body back, either dead or alive, but we cannot find them... you can see the mud,” he told AFP, exhausted after an 18-hour shift.

“It is very traumatic for me too. It is my first time seeing these types of things. Everywhere is mud. We faced flood in Nepal before, but not like this.”

The US Geological Survey said the disaster on the Tibet-Nepal border on Wednesday was caused by a glacial collapse that created a torrent



A woman cries as she waits for updates on whereabouts of her missing family member, in Nuwakot, Nepal. REUTERS

of debris downstream.

While the exact cause of the collapse is unclear, climate change is causing glaciers to melt worldwide, increasing the risks of such disasters.

Survivors face an agonising wait to learn the fate of missing relatives, and the prospect of rebuilding their lives from nothing.

“All the settlements near the river were swept away,” Buddhi Ram Dangol told AFP in Nepal’s Nuwakot district. “There is nothing left.”

At Bidur’s army base, a key rescue hub in the same district, relatives crowded around lists of rescued people pasted on a wall. “I have come here looking for my son,” said Kalka Sharda, scanning the list in desperation. “He was a labourer at the hydropower plant, but I can’t find his name, and the authorities are not saying anything.”

Nepal’s disaster authority has listed 933 hydropower workers among the missing. Others missing were 517 foreigners, including trekkers and Hindu pilgrims to Tibet’s sacred Mount Kailash.

Families, friends wait anxiously

Families of a group of pilgrims from Whitefield and groups originally from Karnataka and living in the US and Canada have been waiting anxiously to hear from them. According to a statement from the state government, 28 persons from Karnataka are stranded or missing.

A brother & a friend fly to Nepal to trace missing TN group

SMITA SHARMA
NUWAKOT (NEPAL)

Helicopters started whirling again in Nuwakot on Saturday, after rescue operations were briefly halted on the previous day in the flash flood-hit northern Nepal amid reports of a lake overflowing at the Chinese border. Racing against time, the choppers are now flying sorties to make the most of clear weather to look for any possible survivors in the border district of Rasuwa, and also ferry relief material to the army camp here from Kathmandu.

Across the barbed wires of the camp, a crowd has gathered. Among them, two tall young men are struggling to convince a Nepal Police officer to be let



Mahmud Hussain (R) and Daniel Ajith at the Nuwakot army camp on Saturday. SMITA SHARMA

inside to take a look at those rescued and brought to the camp. The duo — Mahmud Hussain and Daniel Ajith — carries a list of names and photos of dozens of Indian nationals from Tamil Nadu.

The list has the details of 36 people — part of a larger group of 57, mostly senior citizens.

► **TN group, Page 7**

FROM
THE GROUND

KPSC ‘scam’: CID detains IAS officer Gangwar

Taken into custody
for ‘not cooperating’
with probe

BENGALURU, DHNS



Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar

The Criminal Investigation Department (CID) on Saturday detained IAS officer Gyanendra Kumar Gangwar in connection with the alleged irregularities in the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC) recruitment examination for veterinary officers.

His detention came a day after Gangwar was questioned by CID sleuths for more than nine hours on Friday. He had appeared before the investigating officer in response to a notice issued by the agency.

CID sources said Gangwar was taken into custody for allegedly not cooperating with the investigation and misleading the investigation officials by giving contradictory statements.

The interrogation focused on his role in the examination process during his tenure as

the Controller of Examinations at the KPSC.

The CID is examining the alleged manipulation of the recruitment examination, including the handling of examination records and OMR sheets and the role of officials and alleged intermediaries. Investigators are also examining whether the former examination controller had knowledge of or played a role in the alleged irregularities.

Gangwar, a 2016-batch IAS officer, served as Controllor of Examinations at the KPSC from February 2024 to March 2026. He was subsequently transferred and is currently serving as Director of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) in the Department of Industries and Commerce.

The CID is expected to

ED action this month

The ED raided the premises of Gangwar on August 23. On August 18, the ED had searched 21 premises linked to KPSC and alleged middlemen and the offices of Edutest Solutions Pvt Ltd, the company responsible for digital evaluation of exam papers.

produce Gangwar before the jurisdictional court and seek his custody for further investigation.

A week ago, Gangwar’s whereabouts had triggered a controversy following searches by the ED at his premises. Reports had emerged that he was untraceable after leaving Bengaluru. The state government, however, said he had gone to Uttar Pradesh citing a family emergency involving his father’s health.

The CID and the ED are continuing separate probes to establish the full extent of the alleged KPSC recruitment irregularities and identify all those involved.

State forms panels to oversee cloud seeding

BENGALURU, PTI: In view of the below-normal monsoon rainfall across most parts of the state in the current year, the Karnataka government has constituted two separate committees to ensure the smooth implementation, monitoring and technical guidance of the cloud seeding programme to address rainfall deficit and drought-like situation. **Details on Page 2**

Biometric check for Gruha Lakshmi scheme

BENGALURU, PTI: The Karnataka government will undertake re-verification of beneficiaries registered under the Gruha Lakshmi Scheme through biometric and facial authentication to identify eligible beneficiaries, officials said on Saturday. An order to this effect was issued on August 28 after a detailed examination of the proposal.

Skill development: K’taka forms vision group

BENGALURU, DHNS: Karnataka has constituted “Vision Group for Skill Development”, a high-level advisory body to provide strategic direction to the state’s skilling ecosystem, officials said on Saturday. The Vision Group has been constituted in furtherance of the Karnataka State Skill Policy 2025–32, which articulates the state’s commitment to building a future-ready workforce.

Trump announces ‘biggest’ oil deal with Venezuela

WASHINGTON, AFP: President Donald Trump said on Friday his administration has reached a huge oil deal with Venezuela that gives the US smajority control of 65 billion barrels of proven petroleum reserves.

The deal — which Trump claimed was “the biggest oil deal in world history” — will bring \$100 billion in private investment to Venezuela. **Details on Page 11**



Nitin Nabin

BJP chief pulls up MPs for visiting Sajjan family

NEW DELHI, DHNS: BJP national president Nitin Nabin has pulled up three party MPs from Delhi for visiting the family of former Congress leader and 1984 anti-Sikh riots convict Sajjan Kumar to offer condolences after his death, sources said.

Party sources said Nabin sought an explanation from the MPs and conveyed the leadership’s displeasure over the visit.

Details on Page 10

Rahul calls Haldwani ‘purification’ a crime, seeks FIR

SHEMIN JOY
NEW DELHI, DHNS

Targeting the BJP-RSS for the ‘shuddhikaran’ (purification) carried out at a venue in Utarakhand’s Haldwani where Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge had addressed a rally, Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Saturday termed the incident a “crime” and demanded that Prime Minister Narendra Modi order the registration of an FIR.

Addressing a press conference, Rahul said the incident on August 10 displayed the BJP-RSS “mindset” that they do not want Dalits to progress and live with respect.

The top Congress leader

RSS remarks: Priyank gets bail

Home Minister Priyank Kharge and state Youth Congress chief Mohammed Haris Nalapad on Saturday got bail in a case for alleged defamatory remarks against the RSS. **Details on Page 5**

made it clear that the party wants the Haldwani incident to be recognised as a crime and it is “not a possibility that Kharge does not get justice”. “The Constitution says this is a crime. They are calling this ‘purification’. But this is another name for untouchability,” he said. **► Rahul, Page 7**

SWOLLEN RIVERS



Boats remain moored along the flooded banks of the Ganga and Yamuna rivers in Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh, on Saturday. PTI

BJP to go ahead with padayatra

BENGALURU, DHNS: BJP has decided to go ahead with its Ballari Padayatre, which begins from September 1 from Lingsugur and conclude in Ballari on September 10, while passing through nine Assem-

bled constituencies, mainly the St belt, said former minister B. Sriramulu in a press meet.

Releasing the logo of the padayatra, he said Union Ministers Pralhad Joshi and H D Kumaraswamy, BJP state pres-

ident BY Vijayendra, Leader of Opposition R Ashoka, Legislative Council Opposition Leader Chalavadi Narayanaswamy and several other leaders would take part in the inauguration of the march.

TRAFFIC FIX

Car-free day, tech park shuttles proposed on congested ORR

DH SPECIAL

ASHWIN B M
BENGALURU, DHNS

The Bengaluru Traffic Police has suggested a monthly corporate car-free day and shuttle connectivity between technology parks to reduce private vehicle use and ease congestion on the Outer Ring Road.

Under the proposal, companies would nominate one day every month as a car-free day, when employees would be encouraged not to bring private cars into corporate campuses. The initial framework suggests using entry-gate records and parking occupancy to monitor compliance.

BTP’s suggestion on inter-tech park shuttle system aims to reduce short-distance private vehicle trips on

BTP PROPOSAL

- One Car-Free Day every month
- Companies choose the day
- Private cars discouraged/restricted inside campuses
- Entry gates and parking data to monitor impact

INTER-TECH PARK SHUTTLES

- Connect nearby tech parks
- Reduce short car trips
- Regular shuttle intervals
- Help employees travelling for meetings and vendor coordination
- Improve pedestrian safety



the ORR, where employees frequently travel between nearby campuses for meetings, vendor coordination and shared facilities.

According to BTP, similar shared shuttle loops in Gurugram’s business districts have helped reduce private

trips, parking churn and travel uncertainty. The system could also improve pedestrian safety by enabling employees to move between campuses without using busy ORR footpaths or making unsafe crossings.

Bengaluru city police commission-

1,000 acres of forest in Ballari turned into revenue land

CHIRANJEEVI KULKARNI
BENGALURU, DHNS

More than 1,000 acres of scrub forest in Ballari’s Sandur, enjoying the protection as a reserved forest for more than a century, has been turned into revenue land, thanks to an order passed by the revenue authorities by keeping the forest department in the dark.

The 1,096-acre land parcel in survey numbers 165/A, 165/B, 177/c and 1/B of Somalapur village in Choranur hobli of Sandur taluk were notified as forests by the Madras Presidency on April 1, 1890. They were suddenly turned into ‘B-kharab’ or non-forest revenue lands, thanks to an illegal mutation executed on May 30, 2024.

According to the Forest (Conservation) Act 1980, no forest land can be converted to non-forest land without clearance from the Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change.

However, the revenue authorities in Ballari have converted the land without any clearance.

Documents obtained un-



Rules flouted

Revenue authorities in Ballari convert land without any clearance

Documents obtained under RTI by activist Dinesh Kallahalli show that then assistant commissioner passed order to ‘correct errors’ in RTCs

However, review of old RTCs on Bhoomi portal shows that the RTCs had no such errors

der the Right to Information Act by activist Dinesh Kallahalli show that on January 25, 2024, the then assistant commissioner Hemant N passed an order which ostensibly sought to correct errors in RTC certificates pertaining to 38 survey numbers/part numbers.

► **Forest, Page 7**

Over 500 fake doctors identified in K’taka in 2 years

SNEHA RAMESH
BENGALURU, DHNS

The Karnataka health department has identified as many as 582 fake doctors in the state since 2024, data shows, even as the department has constituted a special investigation team to probe fake drug rackets.

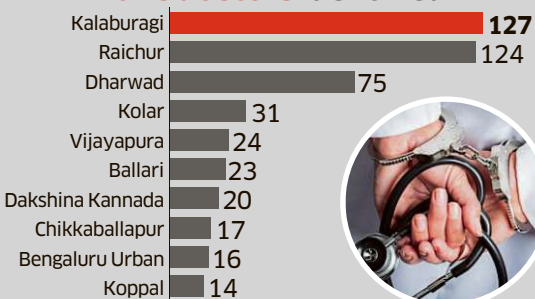
The crackdown on fake doctors intensified in 2025 after the high court pulled up the government over the lack of adequate action against quacks.

Data shows that a majority of the cases were reported from rural areas, with Kalaburagi (127 cases) topping the list followed by Raichur (124 cases) and Dharwad (75 cases).

According to sources, many assistants, ward boys and nurses who would have closely observed doctors tend to open clinics in remote rural areas.

“Many of them would have observed and learnt a few medical details after working with doctors for years and when they set up a clinic in

Districts where highest number of fake doctors identified



I have asked officials to prepare a report with the details of such establishments at taluk level. We will prepare an action plan and implement it soon. We will also hold discussions with the police department and seek their support to intensify the crackdown.

UT Khader, Health Minister

some rural areas, it is easy for them to make people believe,” a senior official in the health department said.

While the cases are higher in rural areas, enforcement might be lagging in urban areas.

“In cities like Bengaluru, there are so many clinics, and

the department may not have enough resources to check on each of them. Hence, the number of fake doctors identified in bigger cities may be lower,” said a senior official who did not want to be named.

Officials have observed several categories of fake doctors. ► **Quacks, Page 7**